

Acer X1260

Compact, pocket friendly performer

The X1260 DLP projector is compact little projector from Acer meant for presentation purposes but it is to be seen if it can do anything more than that.

Firstly, the design is compact with a smooth glossy finish. The remote neatly attaches into the projector and the same can be used as a controller for the projector. The blower fan is located at the front of the projector. The controls and the interface are very simple to understand and navigate through. There are even RS232 and USB controller options so you can use the laptop or the computer to control the projector.

It isn't just the interface and design that makes the Acer attractive. It isn't a bad performer either. The colours

are natural but a little bit on the lower side. The display is crisp at all native resolutions. A lot of the clarity even at the resolution of 1024 x 768 depends on the resolution and quality of the media used. Compressed videos look pretty bad but high definition looks pretty stunning. Change in resolutions takes a lot of time. Focussing is simple and there are no hassles there. There are profiles for different kinds of viewing and these can be customised and saved.

Surprising, the projector doesn't get very hot as some of the others which is always a good thing. The speaker on the projector isn't very loud though so it's better to use an external one. The remote works well but it doesn't



have a really good range so you need to be very close to the projector for it to work. Inputs: VGA, composite, s-video, 3.5-mm audio connector, Weight: 2.27 kg. Dimensions: 26.67 x 7.87 x 18.8 cm

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Web site: www.acer.co.in
Price: Rs 55,776

Specifications

Native resolution: 1024x768, Maximum Resolution: 1440x900, Brightness: 2000 ANSI Lumens, Contrast Ratio: 2000:1, Aspect Ratios: 4:3, 5:4,

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★☆
Performance	★★★★☆
Build Quality	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆

HP Pavillion tx2000

Great config, good performance and a touchscreen!

The HP Pavillion tx2000 is a range of mid-ranged laptops and we have one of the new models with us this month. We have seen this range of laptops in one of our previous comparison tests so its interesting to see how things have changed.

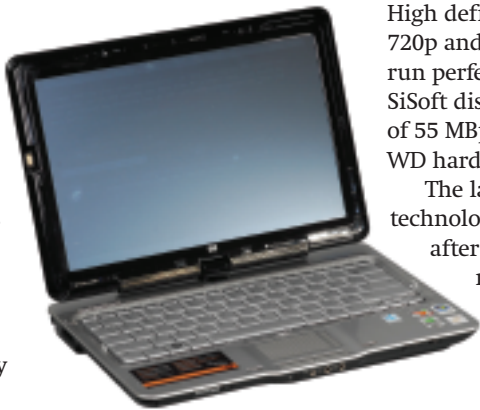
The design of the laptop is very modern. All the panels are glossy and so is the 12-inch 1280 x 800 screen. The specs of this laptop are quite high end other than the graphics solution. It still is much superior to most of the entry level laptops. There is a GeForce Go 6150 onboard graphics solution. The processor is a Turion dual core TL-60 2 GHz processor. The touchscreen is probably

what will make this laptop sell more than anything else. It works well and the rotating hinge mechanism allows smooth rotating of the screen so it can be folded back into itself to be a tablet PC. The touch screen works well especially with Vista's features.

With the 3 GB of memory on the laptop, Vista

runs flawlessly without any hiccups. Benchmarks clearly show the superiority as well. At 640 x 480, *Far Cry* was able to run at an average frame rate of 65.72 fps on medium quality. *Doom 3* gave 16.7 fps. The Altec Lansing speakers deliver as well but the screen is a little disappointing. Viewing angles aren't good but the colours are alright. High definition videos of 720p and 1080p resolutions run perfectly fine on it. SiSoft displayed a drive index of 55 MBps on the 233 GB WD hard drive.

The laptop with its older technology gets really hot after a while in the top right region and under the laptop. With the glossy solid build and



finish, it traps a lot of heat and it can get annoying to use after a while.

For Rs 59,990, it makes an excellent buy for anyone looking for a good compact tablet PC if you are willing to ignore the heating issues.

Specifications

Turion TL-60 2GHz, 3 GB DDR2, 233GB HDD, Vista Home Premium, 12.1-inch LCD screen, Resolution: 1280x800.

Contact:
Hewlett Packard
Phone: +91-124-2566111
E-mail: Diptesh.ghosh@hp.com
Web site: www.hp.com/in
Price: Rs 59,990

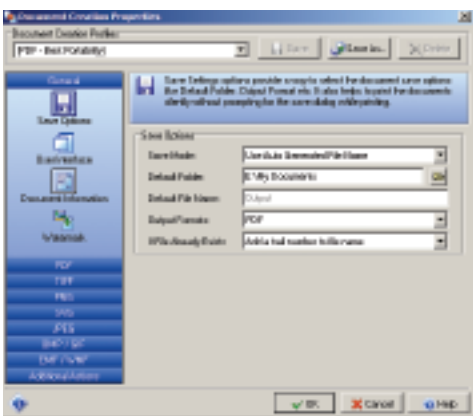
RATINGS	
Features	★★★★☆
Performance	★★★★☆
Build Quality	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆

Gnostice Print2eDoc

A virtual printer that prints PDF on a PC

PDF is a compact format and it's something most people can't do without. Adobe isn't the only one creating applications for PDF. Gnostice has created software called Print2eDoc which prints a document as a PDF file.

Unlike most other free software, Print2eDoc has many features put in place to make the PDF as customisable as possible. The software has been developed particularly for users using Microsoft Office and other similar applications. Installation is simple and the software puts a virtual printer on your PC. All documents can be printed through it to the PDF format as well as other such as TIF,



PNG, SVG and many others. Settings specific to each of the formats are available and these can be saved as profiles to be used later. The core focus however is on PDF file generation. There are options for all kinds of compression and security is handled using

encryption for PDF. There are also other connectivity and notification features. Once a PDF file is created, it can be immediately uploaded to an FTP server or sent by mail. Support for news-group uploading is also available.

The documentation is really helpful with information on every single option and menu. There's even help provided on how to set it up on other Windows operating systems.

The price for the software is around Rs 1,200 (\$30). People who require an application to quickly output PDF file from documents of all sorts will find

this very handy. The ability is to upload files as necessary is also very useful. For most users who need PDFs created for home use might not find Gnostice Print2eDoc of much use.

Requirements

Windows 2000 and XP, Hardware requirements: 1.4 GHz processor, 128 MB of RAM, 5 MB of drive space.

Contact:
Gnostice Information Technologies Pvt Ltd.
Phone: +91-9343770413
E-mail: info@gnostice.com
Web site: www.gnostice.com
Price: \$29 (Rs 1,200)

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★☆
Performance	★★★★☆
Ease of Use	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆

HP Officejet H470

Mobile jet

The HP Officejet H470 is one of the few portable inkjet printers to come by. Unlike some of the ultra portable printers that usually are designed to print just photo, the H470 can do pretty much everything a desktop printer can. We go hunting for a weakness in this Officejet H470.

The H470 is much

smaller in comparison than a desktop printer but it can still print A4 size pages just fine. The build quality isn't the best as everything in a desktop printer has been compacted into the cramped space.

When it comes to quality it takes some time but it prints the high quality photo prints rather well. There is some excess saturation of colours but keeps the contrast levels high. The photo quality printout took 4:34 mins to print. Speeds for the standard quality text prints were around 10 sec-



onds. The normal quality text print one took 3 seconds more. The difference in the economical and the standard quality prints are very obvious. The normal prints look thick and display some shadowing.

The economical modes show a good amount of quality degradation. Lines seem edged and aren't smooth. There were signs of colours mixing up and lot of banding issues. There are also protruding edges of colours spilling on the sides of straight lines.

Some of the HP Officejet H470 additional features have wireless networking capabilities using WiFi which is an optional as well through Bluetooth. It also comes with a battery like on a laptop so you don't always have to carry the power adaptor everywhere you go.

Rs 13,899 is a high price to ask for a printer even a compact one like the H470.

There are a few obvious issues with fast prints and if quality isn't what you need but just speed, then the H470 would be perfect. The entire idea of being to carry a printer around in independently is what makes this printer special and if that's what you need, it makes a worthy purchase.

Specifications

Print quality: 1600 x 1600 dpi, cartridges (black and colour) Dimensions: 34 x 16.4 x 8.3 cm

Contact:
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Phone: +91-124-2566111
E-mail: ashwini-k.aggarwal@hp.com
Web site: www.hp.com/in
Price: Rs 13,899

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★☆
Performance	★★★★☆
Build Quality	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆